

Problem 5. Kavalan (25 marks)

Different languages use different strategies to focus on particular words in the sentence. For example, English speakers change their tone of voice to emphasize a particular word: *Mary drank the water* and *Mary drank the water* have different meanings. You can even extract the subject for extra emphasis: *Mary, she drank the water*. Other languages have different strategies.

Kavalan is a critically endangered language spoken in Taiwan. As of 2000 it only had 24 remaining speakers, most of whom were elderly. Below are some sentences in Kavalan in a simplified transcription, along with their English translations. Focused words or phrases are underlined.

qasirr ya tiapzangawcia	<i><u>That crab</u> is fast.</i>
tmaytaiku tu rrutung	<i><u>I</u> see the monkey.</i>
qananti na sunisku ya liuqay qamasimna	<i>My child begins to eat <u>his rotten sour orange</u>.</i>
ipirisu ni	<i>Do you hear?</i>
ipiransu ya taquzay lamuku	<i>You hear <u>my sleeping village</u>.</i>
tikiskisku tu tarreb ya sarriqsu	<i>I cut the box with <u>your knife</u>.</i>
tmataktiina tu rasung ta buqankuan	<i><u>He</u> begins to dig the well in my sand.</i>
qman tu kitutay taquq ya wasucia ta Kalinkuan	<i><u>That dog</u> eats the small chicken in Hualien.</i>
liuq ya qamasim	<i>The <u>sour orange</u> is rotten.</i>
tipukunti na suniscia tu taquq ya tunun	<i>That child begins to hit the chicken with <u>the stick</u>.</i>
tatakan na wasuku ya rasung	<i>My dog digs <u>the well</u>.</i>
tmutun tu krisiwcia ya tazungan ni	<i>Does <u>the woman</u> burn that money?</i>
rrasaansu ya rrutungcia ni	<i>Do you buy <u>that monkey</u>?</i>
taytaannati ya busarray wasuta	<i>He begins to see <u>our white dog</u>.</i>
busarr ya buqan ta Taypakan ni	<i>Is <u>the sand</u> white in Taipei?</i>
titaytasu tu kitutay lamu ya matasu	<i>You see the small village with <u>your eyes</u>.</i>

Q 5.1 Translate the following sentences into English, indicating the focused words or phrases by underlining:

1. **taquz ya rrutungna**
2. **tutunan na tazungan ya Taypak ni**
3. **tirrasana tu tatakay taquqku ya krisiwta**
4. **kmiskistiita tu kitutay qamasim ta lamuciaan**

Q 5.2 Translate the following sentences into Kavalan:

5. *Am I small?*
6. *His eating child hears your fast dog.*
7. *Does our crab begin to sleep in that box?*
8. *We begin to dig the well with my knife.*
9. *You begin to see that monkey in the well.*

Q 5.3 Explain your solution.